

The Complete Financial Guide for Young Couples

He responded, "I suppose not." That point was made clear in previous counseling sessions when he discussed increasing his office hours to make more money. His annual income was about \$180,000.

"Are you familiar with the story in 2 Kings about an Assyrian army captain by the name of Naaman who went to Israel to be healed of leprosy?" I asked. He said he had heard the story before. So I continued. Naaman heard there was a prophet in Israel who served the true God and could heal even lepers. So he headed toward Israel with his troops. But instead of going out to meet the captain, Elisha sent a messenger to tell Naaman to go down to the Jordan River, dunk himself seven times, and his flesh would be restored.

Naaman was furious and stormed away, saying, "Behold, I thought, 'He will surely come out to me, and stand and call on the name of the Lord his God, and wave his hand over the place, and cure the leper.' " Then one of his servants asked him, "My father, had the prophet told you to do some great thing, would you not have done it?" And of course Naaman said yes. Then the servant said, "How much more then, when he says to you, 'Wash and be clean?'" And so Naaman went down to the river, dunked himself seven times, and when he came up the seventh time, his leprosy was gone (see 2 Kings 5:1-14).

I concluded, "The principle behind this story is that God works best with a humble spirit." What I then asked the doctor to do was mow lawns on his day off (Wednesdays) until he had paid off the smallest of his debts (about \$160).

"That's stupid. I'm not going to do that," he retorted. "I'm a radiologist. I can make more than that in one hour."

I reminded him, "What you make is not the issue here. It's what you spend. But you don't have to do it. It's just a suggestion." He looked at his wife as if to say, "How did you tell him what I said without me knowing about it?" Then he stormed out of my office with his wife in tow.

She waited until they were nearly home before she said, "Are you going to do what you promised God?" He stomped